



FIVE

ELEMENTS

SMOKY MOUNTAINS GUEST GUIDE
PIGEON FORGE · TENNESSEE

Welcome to the mountains. We're so glad you're here.

This binder has everything for your stay, how the cabin works, the best places to eat and play, an easy Gatlinburg day trip, and a few local things worth knowing before you head out.

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1 · Welcome & House Essentials

The quick-reference page. Fields marked with a blank line are for the host to fill in.

WiFi network	_____
WiFi password	_____
Check-in	After ____:____ · self check-in with your unique door code
Check-out	Before ____:____ · see the checklist below
Door / entry	Your unique code was sent before arrival. The whole cabin is yours.
Address	406 Southern Sun Way, Pigeon Forge, TN 37863
Parking	Flat driveway, room for up to 4 vehicles.
Trash day	_____
Thermostat	_____
Pets	_____

Use Google Maps to find us

This is a brand-new cabin, so right now only **Google Maps** locates 406 Southern Sun Way reliably. **Apple Maps** and **Waze** may send you the wrong way, please set your route in Google Maps.

Your amenities

Private indoor heated pool

YEAR-ROUND

Swim rain or shine. Heated, 3 ft deep throughout, with a keyed safety lock. Pool towels are provided. Please keep the door locked and supervise children at all times, there is no lifeguard.

Hot tub & deck

OUTDOORS

A hot tub for star-gazing, plus lounge seating, a gas grill, and string lights. Rinse off before getting in, and keep the cover on when not in use.

Game room & living room

INDOORS

A multi-cade arcade and smart TV, plus a large sectional and a gas fireplace in the living room. Great for movie nights and rainy afternoons.

4 ensuite suites · sleeps 12

BEDROOMS

Two king suites, one queen suite with two queens, and a bunk room with full-over-full beds, each with its own full bath and smart TV. Full kitchen and washer/dryer on site.

Before you check out

- Start the dishwasher and put any trash in the outside bins (lids closed, see bear note).
- Return furniture to where you found it and gather used towels in the bathrooms.
- Turn off lights, lock the indoor pool door, and set the thermostat as instructed.
- Make sure all doors are locked and the door code panel is closed.

2 · Things to Do

The headliners of the Smokies, all a short drive from your door.

Dollywood

THEME PARK · ~10-12 MIN

One of America's most-awarded parks: world-class coasters, craft shows, festivals, and Smoky Mountain food. New for 2026: NightFlight Expedition, an indoor adventure coaster.

Tip: arrive at opening, ride headliners first, save shows for midday.

The Island in Pigeon Forge

FREE TO STROLL · ~7 MIN

A walkable hub with the 200-ft Great Smoky Mountain Wheel, a dancing fountain show, shops, snacks, an arcade, and Ole Smoky Moonshine.

Best for: an easy evening with the whole group.

Great Smoky Mountains National Park

FREE ENTRY · ~15 MIN

The most-visited park in the country. Drive Cades Cove, Newfound Gap, and Roaring Fork; hike to Laurel Falls or Andrews Bald. A parking tag is required to stop (see Good to Know).

Tip: go early for wildlife and parking.

Moonshine & distillery tastings

ADULTS

Tennessee's legal-moonshine country: Ole Smoky (at The Island), Old Forge Distillery, Tennessee Shine Co., and Junction 35. Cheap tasting flights and short tours.

Tip: go earlier; weekend evenings get busy.

Dinner shows

DINNER + SHOW

Dolly Parton's Stampede (horses + a four-course meal), the Hatfield & McCoy Dinner Feud (comedy + feast), and Pirates Voyage (acrobatics on a ship).

Best for: a no-cooking-tonight family night. Book ahead.

Mountain coasters & ziplines

THRILL

Gravity-fed alpine coasters you control yourself, plus zipline canopy tours, Smoky Mountain Alpine Coaster, Rowdy Bear, Goats on a Roof, Smoky Mountain Ziplines.

Best for: teens and thrill-seekers.

3 · Kids & Family

Water parks, go-karts, hands-on museums, and rainy-day winners.

Dollywood's Splash Country

SUMMER WATER PARK

Slides, a wave pool, and a lazy river next to Dollywood. A must on a hot day; runs seasonally, so check the calendar.

Best for: beating the summer heat.

WonderWorks

HANDS-ON SCIENCE

The upside-down building on the Parkway: 100+ interactive exhibits, an indoor ropes course, and laser tag.

A great rainy-day plan.

The Track / Adventure Raceway

GO-KARTS & MINI-GOLF

Multi-level go-kart tracks, mini-golf, bumper boats, kiddie rides, and an arcade, the classic Pigeon Forge midway.

Best for: burning off energy after dinner.

Titanic Museum Attraction

INTERACTIVE HISTORY

Walk aboard a half-scale Titanic with a real boarding pass, touch a real iceberg, and feel the sloping decks.

Best for: ages 6+ and history buffs.

Pigeon Forge Snow

INDOOR SNOW

Real indoor snow, year-round, for snow tubing and a kids' play area. A fun way to cool off.

Best for: little ones and novelty.

A day in at the cabin

FREE · AT HOME

Your cabin is its own attraction: a morning in the indoor pool, a game-room tournament, the grill, then the hot tub after dark.

Reminder: keep the pool door locked; no lifeguard.

4 • Where to Eat

Local-favorite Southern cooking, big-group spreads, steaks, and famous pancakes.

The Old Mill Restaurant

SOUTHERN • HISTORIC

Comfort-food landmark by a working grist mill. Fried chicken, pot pie, meatloaf, and scratch breakfasts. Breakfast served till 11am.

Try: fried chicken and the fresh-milled cornbread.

The Pottery House Café & Grille

BISTRO-SOUTHERN

Across Old Mill Square: Southern plates with a bistro twist, served on pottery made next door. Quiches, sandwiches, salads, desserts.

Try: a patio table by the fountain.

Mama's Farmhouse

FAMILY-STYLE • GROUPS

All-you-can-eat bowls of Southern home cooking, passed family-style. The easy move for a big cabin group.

Best for: feeding twelve without a fuss.

Sawyer's Farmhouse

BREAKFAST • PANCAKES

Big farmhouse breakfast, pancakes, French toast, omelets, loaded platters. Fuel up before a park day.

Tip: go early; the line builds fast.

Alamo Steakhouse

STEAK • DATE NIGHT

Hand-cut steaks grilled over oak, with scratch soups and sauces. The grown-up dinner out.

Try: the Texas T-Bone or a bone-in ribeye.

The Local Goat

NEW AMERICAN

Scratch-made plates with local beef, craveable burgers, and a deep craft-beer list. Lively and casual.

Best for: a relaxed group dinner.

Huck Finn's Catfish

SOUTHERN • CATFISH

Southern catfish and fried chicken with bottomless sides, white beans, slaw, hush puppies, fries.

Save room for cobbler.

Puckett's

BBQ • LIVE MUSIC

Tennessee BBQ: slow-smoked pulled pork and brisket, generous sides, a relaxed music-friendly vibe.

Try: the BBQ plate with skillet mac & cheese.

Pancakes & dinner shows

Pigeon Forge is the unofficial pancake capital of the South, you'll pass a great pancake house every few blocks. For dinner-and-a-show, the big three are Dolly Parton's Stampede, the Hatfield & McCoy Dinner Feud, and Pirates Voyage. Reserve at least a week ahead in summer and October.

5 · House Rules

A few essentials so everyone has a great, safe stay. (Provisional, final rules to be confirmed by host.)

- **No smoking** anywhere on the property, indoors or out. Violations incur a \$500 fee.
- A **\$500 refundable security deposit** hold is placed for the stay and released after checkout if there is no damage.
- **Indoor pool:** keep the keyed pool door locked and never let children swim unsupervised. The pool is 3 ft deep throughout and there is no lifeguard.
- Please respect the listed maximum of **12 guests**; no parties or events.
- Keep noise neighborly, especially after dark, this is a residential road.
- Pets: _____ (host to confirm).
- Quiet hours / additional rules: _____.

Treat the cabin like your own mountain home and it'll treat you right. Thank you!

6 · Stock Up Nearby

Groceries, pharmacy, delivery, and treats, a short hop down the Parkway.

Food City

CLOSEST GROCERY

3625 Parkway, Pigeon Forge, right on the Parkway. Open about 7am-midnight daily. Phone (865) 453-4977.

The convenient full grocery closest to the cabin.

Kroger

OPEN LATE · PHARMACY

220 Wears Valley Rd, just off the Parkway. Open late, with an in-store pharmacy. Pharmacy (865) 429-7127.

Big selection and a pharmacy under one roof.

Publix

DELI & BAKERY

2656 Parkway (Valley Forge Shopping Center), Pigeon Forge. About 7am-9pm, with a pharmacy.

Great deli and bakery; easy in-and-out.

Walmart Supercenter

24 HOURS

1414 Parkway, Sevierville, about 10-12 min up the Parkway. Open 24 hours, with a pharmacy.

Lowest-cost one-stop for anything you forgot.

Pharmacy & convenience

WALGREENS / CVS

Several locations along the Parkway in Pigeon Forge and Sevierville, plus the grocery pharmacies above for prescriptions and OTC basics.

Delivery & treats

DOORDASH / UBER EATS

Both deliver widely across Pigeon Forge. For treats, the creameries and candy at The Island and the Old Mill Candy Kitchen are local favorites.

7 · Day Trip: Gatlinburg

About 10 minutes south, where the Parkway meets the national park.

Gatlinburg SkyLift Park & SkyBridge

THE VIEW

Ride the chairlift up Crockett Mountain, then walk the SkyBridge, at 680 ft, the longest pedestrian suspension bridge in North America, with glass-floor panels. 2026: about \$30 adults / \$22 kids.

Tip: sunset is stunning; buy combo tickets online.

Anakeesta

MOUNTAINTOP PARK

A gondola climbs to a 16-bridge Treetop Skywalk, the Anavista Tower, ziplines, a mountain coaster, and gardens.

Best for: views, kids, and a little thrill.

Ripley's Aquarium of the Smokies

ALL AGES

10,000+ sea creatures, a glass underwater shark tunnel, and touch tanks at 88 River Road.

A top rainy-day pick for families.

Ober Mountain

YEAR-ROUND

An aerial tram up Mount Harrison: skiing and snow tubing in winter; alpine slide and mountain coaster the rest of the year.

Best for: winter snow or summer rides.

Great Smoky Arts & Crafts Community

LOCAL MAKERS

The country's largest group of independent artisans, 100+ studios along an 8-mile loop east of downtown.

Best for: souvenirs with a story.

Downtown Parkway & The Village

STROLL & SIP

Moonshine and whiskey tastings (Sugarlands, Ole Smoky), the European-style Village Shops, candy makers, and live music.

Tip: park once and walk; lots fill fast midday.

8 • Season by Season

What to expect all year, and the standout events each season.

Spring • March-May

- Wildflowers everywhere, the park is nicknamed "Wildflower National Park."
- Dollywood reopens for the season; smaller crowds than summer.
- Mild days, cool nights, pack layers.
- Late May/June: the famous synchronous fireflies at Elkmont (lottery access).

Summer • June-August

- Peak season: Splash Country open, everything running.
- Warm and humid with brief afternoon storms.
- Book Dollywood, dinner shows, and tours ahead, they sell out.
- July 4th fireworks and festivals along the Parkway.

Fall • September-November

- Leaf season is the big one, color usually peaks mid-to-late October.
- Dollywood Harvest Festival and Great Pumpkin LumiNights.
- Crisp, gorgeous hiking weather.
- Heads-up: October weekends are very busy, start days early.

Winter • December-February

- Millions of lights: Dollywood's Smoky Mountain Christmas and area-wide Winterfest.
- Ober Mountain skiing and tubing; Pigeon Forge Snow year-round.
- Best deals and shortest lines of the year.
- Snow/ice is possible, check mountain road conditions before higher drives.

9 · Good to Know & Bear Safety

A little local know-how keeps your trip smooth and safe.

You're in black-bear country

The park is home to roughly 1,500 black bears, and they do wander into neighborhoods and cabins.

- **Never feed or approach wildlife.** In the park it is illegal to willfully come within 50 yards (150 ft) of a bear or elk.
- **Secure all food and trash.** Don't leave food, coolers, or leftovers on the deck, by the grill, or visible in the car. Keep bin lids closed.
- If you see a bear, enjoy it from a distance, use your phone's zoom, not your feet.
- If a bear approaches: stay calm, pick up small children, make yourself look big, and back away slowly. Do not run.
- Black bears are not grizzlies, if one actually attacks, do NOT play dead. Fight back, aiming for the face and muzzle.

Mountain roads & the national park

- Mountain roads wind and can fog up, slow down, take breaks, and go easy on cruise control.
- The park has **no entrance fee**, but a "Park It Forward" parking tag is required to stop more than 15 minutes: about \$5/day, \$15/week, \$40/year.
- Buy tags at [recreation.gov](https://www.recreation.gov) or [smokiesinformation.org](https://www.smokiesinformation.org), at visitor centers, or at REI on Teaster Lane. Print it, digital tags aren't accepted. Driving through is free.
- The Parkway strip backs up midday in season; mornings are calmer, and the Gatlinburg bypass skips some traffic.
- Mountain weather changes fast and runs cooler at elevation, bring a layer even in summer.

10 · Emergency & Contacts

Keep this page handy.

Emergency (police / fire / medical)	911
Your host, Dru	562-528-6964 · or message via Airbnb / VRBO
Cabin address	406 Southern Sun Way, Pigeon Forge, TN 37863
Nearest hospital	LeConte Medical Center, 742 Middle Creek Rd, Sevierville (about 15-20 min)
Non-emergency police	Pigeon Forge Police (non-emergency): _____ (host to confirm)
Pharmacy (late)	Walmart, 1414 Parkway, Sevierville (24 hrs); Kroger pharmacy (865) 429-7127
WiFi help	Network & password on Page 1; restart the router by the TV if needed.

Thank you for staying with us

We hope Five Elements is the easy, restful base for a wonderful Smoky Mountain trip. If anything isn't right during your stay, message Dru and we'll make it right. Safe travels!